announced that it would host Australian units for joint exercises in Hawaii on a semiannual basis. In mid-October, Newsom and the Philippines president announced that the US alliance with the Philippines would be restricted to political cooperation and economic aid, and that the United States would lose access to any Philippine military bases, effectively ending US security guarantees to Manila and canceling annual defense exercises such as Balikatan.

The second bloc, headed by China, re-created a large portion of the traditional Sinic state system. Taiwan moved first, announcing the week after Newsom's address that it had entered a "new era" in cross-strait relations, whereby Beijing had assured Taipei of a "one country–two systems" arrangement that would preserve Taiwan's autonomous status. China would, however, control the island's foreign policy through a new coordination group, and the two capitals announced in October the formation of an exclusive economic partnership, expanding the 2010 Economic Cooperation Framework Agreement. Taipei agreed to begin downsizing its military into a militia designed to maintain public order, act as a coast guard, and monitor airspace over the island. It further agreed to cease all foreign weapons purchases (thereby making irrelevant the secret US promise to China to stop selling arms to Taiwan).

In what became known as the "St. Valentine's Day Massacre," Seoul announced in mid-February 2026 that it was withdrawing from the US-ROK alliance and was entering into a military "friendship pact" with China, whereby Beijing would undertake to ensure peace and stability on the peninsula. The remaining US troops (seven thousand) would be withdrawn by April Fool's Day 2027, and PLAN vessels would be accorded routine porting privileges at Inchon and Busan. It was unclear whether the Newsom administration was aware of Seoul's plans, despite high-level diplomatic talks that had been ongoing since the September cease-fire. This surprise was followed by the promulgation of a formal alliance between North Korea and China, with DPRK forces joining the PLA in joint naval and air exercises, while Seoul and